My father went off, then—he had to get back to the candy store— and Campbell and I lunched together. I had an idea for another posi-tronic robot story to be called "Little Lost Robot," and I advanced it. I didn't think I would have a chance to write it until the discharge question was settled one way or the other, but I didn't like to see Campbell without advancing any ideas.

After that I went up to Columbia and saw Dawson for the first time in almost a year. I told him I was doing my best to get out of the Army and back into Columbia, and he was most enthusiastic (or, in his

kindhearted way, he pretended to be). My next step was to register for a housing project that Columbia was planning to sponsor in Nyack. (After all, I would have to live somewhere.)

Gertrude and I went for two trips along the boardwalk to Coney Island—alone on June 13, and along with Roy Machlowitz and a friend of his on the fifteenth. Roy visited New York regularly and, almost as regularly, visited Gertrude or called her—which was good, because I could rely on him for news about her.

Roy sometimes expressed apologetic embarrassment at escaping the draft. He had a history of rheumatic fever from which he had recovered completely in everyone's eyes but those of the draft board. I brushed it off and finally put an end to his apologies by saying rather sharply that if his induction meant my discharge then I would push for his induction—but that since I stayed in the Army whether he was in or out, he might as well stay out.

On June 21, my furlough was in its last day and I got back on the train for Camp Lee—and on that same day, Gertrude got a letter reinstating her allotment. The whole thing had been a clerical error, and I was not out of the Army.

Actually, I didn't think I was, and I didn't complain. The error got me two weeks in New York with Gertrude and reassignment to Camp Lee, where I could push for discharge. Without the error, I would have been on Bikini with the other specialists for three weeks now and with considerable additional time to go.

I felt too relieved that this had not happened to feel properly guilty.

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On June 22, 1946, I was back in Camp Lee, exactly sixteen weeks after I had